



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Summit Christian Academy

School Website: <https://summit-christian-academy.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **STARTUP** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Summit Christian Academy (Lee's Summit, MO, 64081) presents as a Christian private school with an explicit emphasis on academic excellence and godly character. Public-facing materials characterize the school as Kansas City's largest accredited independent Christian school and highlight a mission rooted in faith-centered formation of students. However, the available public materials do not clearly articulate a classical curriculum or classical pedagogical program (e.g., the Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or formal Socratic/seminar-based pedagogy). When mapped against the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School rubric, Summit Christian Academy exhibits limited classical credentials in curriculum content, pedagogy, and community practices, with modest alignment in the religious/metaphysical dimension and virtue-formation language. The aggregate assessment therefore lands in NOT CLASSICAL, with notable RED/ORANGE signals in two categories where foundational classical elements—deep engagement with the liberal arts, Great Books, and classical pedagogy—are not explicitly evidenced on public-facing materials.

Key evidentiary notes drawn from the public website materials and classical-education knowledge framework:

- The site foregrounds Christian identity and character formation (godly character) as a core aim, which aligns with the religious/virtue-oriented axis of classical education but stops short of explicit transcendental realism or liturgical practice in the public text. This religious framing is supported by homepage language calling SCA a Christian school and highlighting godly character (turn1file0).
- There is no explicit public articulation of classical curriculum components (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium; Great Conversation; scholé; liturgical practices) in the visible pages. The available crawl content emphasizes recruitment and visitation (shadow-a-student tours, signage about joining) rather than curricular commitments (turn1file3).
- Classical-education knowledge artifacts (Six Essential Elements) provide explicit keyword frames for assessing a school's alignment (e.g., Great Books; Trivium; scholé; liturgy; partnership with families; formation of affections). When compared to Summit Christian Academy's public materials, the school's visible language touches virtue/character and Christian identity but lacks explicit Great Books/Trivium pedagogy, scholarly memory-work, and the Great Conversation signals. See the six-element rubric and keyword lexicon for reference (e.g., truth/goodness/beauty; Trivium; Great Books; scholé; liturgy; partnership with families) (see Six Essential Elements documents and lexicon).

Executive judgments by category (categorized against the Six Essential Elements framework):

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**
- Evidence: Public materials emphasize Christian identity, "godly character," and the Christian orientation of the school (turn1file0). This aligns with the Religious/Metaphysical Foundations axis of virtue formation and theology.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators present include explicit Christian framing (which maps to virtue formation and theological grounding in practice). Direct references to truth/goodness/beauty or liturgical practices are not shown in the visible homepage text; however, the Christian foundation supplies a grounding in virtue and spiritual formation. According to the Six Elements lexicon, virtue, transcendentals, and theology are central positive indicators; the site shows virtue-language (godly character) and theology-grounded framing implicitly through Christian identity. There are no explicit negative signals in the public text.
- Why this rating: The school demonstrates a religious/character-formation orientation consistent with Christian formation, which is a partial alignment with classical foundations, but it lacks explicit transcendental-moral-realism language and liturgical/communal practices on the public-facing pages. The result is a partial classical signal rather than a full classical articulation. (Citations: homepage content; classical lexicon anchors on virtue/theology as core signals)
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public language emphasizes “academic excellence” and “godly character” as aims. These map to formation and virtue-language rather than a purely information-based, job-prep mission. The absence of explicit “Great Conversation” or “formation over information” phrasing in public text reduces the classical scoring.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include formation of character and virtue language (godly character → virtue/formation). No explicit counter-indicators are visible in the accessible material.
- Why this rating: Summit’s stated aims suggest formation and virtue as central, aligning with the classical aim for formation and moral development; however, explicit classical telos statements (truth/goodness/beauty as knowable) and the Great Books/Great Conversation framing are not present on the visible pages. This yields a partial (SOMEWHAT) alignment rather than full CLASSICAL. (Citations: homepage content)
- Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The public-facing site text centers on Christian identity and recruitment; there is no explicit mention of Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, Great Conversation, or a liberal-arts curriculum. The crawl content available focuses on admissions, tours, and general description rather than curricular specifics (turn1file3).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: No direct matches to Trivium, Great Books, or history-as-Grand Conversation in the accessible public text; thus no positive classical curriculum signals are evidenced.
- Why this rating: Without explicit Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric, or a historically grounded liberal-arts framework, the school’s curriculum does not reflect classical curriculum content. (Citations: homepage lines; firecrawl admissions/tour content)
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: No explicit public statements about Socratic seminars, scholé, chant/memorization, or classical pedagogy in the accessible website material. The visible content emphasizes admissions and visit options rather than pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: No clear positive classical pedagogy indicators (e.g., Socratic method, memorization, chant, or disciplined dialogue). No explicit negative signals are visible either in the accessible text, but the lack of evidence for classical pedagogy is decisive.
- Why this rating: The absence of stated classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue, memory work, or disciplined classical pedagogy) supports a NOT CLASSICAL designation in pedagogy. (Citations: site admissions/visit content)
- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence: Public-facing content does not describe a living curriculum by faculty, a teacher portrait, or a mentorship framework. The visible text centers on school branding rather than faculty philosophy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: No explicit signals about teacher role modeling, living curriculum, or faculty-as-mentors appear in the public text.
- Why this rating: In the absence of public statements about faculty as model-mentors or a lived, virtue-centered faculty profile, the school does not demonstrate classical faculty characteristics on the available materials. (Citations: home/admission content)
- Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The site emphasizes admissions, tours, and shadowing opportunities, with no explicit articulation of parents as co-teachers, formation of affections, or structured parent-education programs. The Six Elements framework highlights strong parent-partnership signals as a core classical anchor; these are not clearly present in the accessible public text (aside from invitation to visits) (turn1file3).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: No explicit “partnership with families,” “parent formation,” or “open-campus parent involvement” signals are evident in the accessible public copy.
- Why this rating: While the school welcomes families to visits, there is insufficient public articulation of a classical-parent partnership model or active parent formation programs. Public signals align more with standard private Christian school operations than with a classical-parent-partnership model. (Citations: homepage/admissions content)

Aggregate assessment - The six-category rubric yields two categories with SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals (Religious/Metaphysical Foundations; School Purpose and Goal) and four categories with NOT CLASSICAL signals (Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community). The overall, aggregate rating therefore falls into NOT CLASSICAL.

- What would move the needle (for a path toward CLASSICAL)
- Explicitly adopt and publish a classical curriculum framework, including:
- Seven liberal arts framing (Trivium and Quadrivium) and integration with Great Books and Great Conversation (development of reading original texts, primary sources, and historical texts). Reference: Six Essential Elements’ emphasis on Great Books, Great Conversation, and the Trivium/Quadrivium as foundational modes of learning. Public articulation of such a program would move the Curriculum category to CLASSICAL and raise Pedagogy toward Socratic/seminar-based modalities.
- Publicly describe a Scholé-friendly cadence: contemplative/restful learning interwoven with rigorous study; memorization, chant, or recitation in lower grades; Socratic or seminar-style discussions in upper grades; and opportunities for formal rhetoric in later years. This would move Pedagogy into CLASSICAL territory.
- Elevate faculty as the living curriculum: publish explicit statements about teachers modeling virtue, mentoring, and forming a “portrait” or profile of the teacher-student ideal. This would move Faculty toward CLASSICAL.
- Strengthen Parent & Community partnership: establish formal, publicized co-teaching roles for parents, parent-education programs, and open-campus/parent-formation activities consistent with classical education norms. This would move Parents & Community toward CLASSICAL.
- Deepen theological/themetical integration with the curriculum: explicit grounding in truth/goodness/beauty as real and knowable, with liturgical or communal practices that integrate worship/music as part of the learning rhythm. This would strengthen Religious and Metaphysical Foundations toward CLASSICAL.
- References for these moves come from the classical-education literature and the Six Essential Elements canon, which emphasize Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Conversation, scholé, and strong parent/community partnership as core to a classical school (see Six Essential Elements documents and lexicon).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials emphasize Christian identity and a godly character as core aims (turn1file0).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators present: Christian identity; character formation language (mapped to virtue formation).
- Negative indicators: Not explicitly visible; no hard negative signals detected in the accessible copy.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates a religiously grounded, virtue-oriented foundation, which aligns with classical aims in spirit, but it does not overtly articulate transcendental moral realism or liturgical practices on public materials. This yields a partial but not full classical signal in this category.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Emphasis on academic excellence and godly character as central aims (turn1file0).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive: formation/virtue-oriented aims, framed as character development.
- Negative: lack of explicit classical telos language (truth/goodness/beauty as knowable; Great Conversation).
- Why this rating
- The formation-focused language resembles classical formation aims, but the public articulation does not firmly establish classical telos or the Great Conversation. Hence, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No explicit mention of Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or Great Conversation on the public site portion captured by the crawl (turn1file3).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators: None directly observable in public text.
- Negative indicators: Not explicit; however, lack of classical curriculum signals is decisive.
- Why this rating
- Absence of explicit classical curriculum content or Great Books framework places the category in NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Public materials show admissions/tour content rather than pedagogy. No explicit classical pedagogy language (Socratic, scholé, chanting, etc.) in accessible copy (turn1file3).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators: None explicit in accessible text.
- Negative indicators: Not explicit in public content; classical pedagogy signals are not evidenced.
- Why this rating
- The absence of classical pedagogy descriptions yields NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- No explicit faculty portrait or “living curriculum” statements in the public copy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: None in accessible text.
- Negative indicators: None explicit, but lack of classical faculty signals drives NOT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
- Without public-facing statements about model-mentors, virtue-formed teaching, or faculty as core “living curriculum,” Element 5 remains NOT CLASSICAL.

Element 6: Parents & Community — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
- Admissions/tour content; no public articulation of parent-as-co-teacher models or parent formation programs (turn1file3).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
- Positive indicators: Visit/tour invitations show family involvement but not the deeper classical partnership model.
- Negative indicators: Absence of explicit parent-partnership language (co-teaching, formation, book clubs, liturgies, etc.)
- Why this rating
- Not clearly aligned with classical parent/community practices in public materials.

Aggregate assessment: NOT CLASSICAL

- SCA shows Christian identity and character-formation language in public materials (SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL signals in Categories 1–2) but lacks explicit classical curriculum, pedagogy, faculty living-forms, and parent-community frameworks (NOT CLASSICAL signals in Categories 3–6). The combination yields an overall NOT CLASSICAL classification.

What Would Move the Needle

- Publish and implement a formal classical curriculum framework (explicitly include):
- The liberal arts core (Trivium and Quadrivium) with a Great Books/Great Conversation track.
- Scholé-based rhythms (restful study) and memory work in early grades; Socratic seminars and rhetoric opportunities in upper grades.
- A living-faculty model that presents teachers as virtuous mentors and living curriculum.
- A formal partnership with parents as co-educators, with parent education programs and regular involvement in classical-education activities.
- Theological/Religious Foundations integrated with curricular content (truth/goodness/beauty as real and knowable; liturgical rhythms if desired in a Christian context).
- Evidence-based alignment references: Six Essential Elements provides the canonical classical signals (Great Books; Great Conversation; Trivium/Quadrivium; scholé; teacher as living curriculum; parent partnership). The school would move toward CLASSICAL by publicly embracing these elements as core to program design and daily practice.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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